

Section A

Students will be assessed on their ability to identify aurally the key musical features in some of the set works from the areas of study. They should understand the context within which the set works were composed and their place within the area of study as a whole.

Students will also be expected to express and justify opinions on the set work extracts and complete short musical dictation and staff notation questions.

Further details for Section A include:

- eight questions requiring students to respond to extracts of music, of which:
 - six questions will be based on extracts of the set works
 - one question will be on musical dictation. This will be worth 6–10 marks
 - one question will be on an unfamiliar piece (closely related to a set work) with an accompanying skeleton score. This will be worth 8 marks
- the exact number of times the extracts will be heard is announced on the audio and printed on the examination paper
- students will be given reading time at the start of each question and time to complete their answers at the end of each question
- a range of question types, including multiple choice, melody/rhythm completion, grid completion, one-word response, short response and free response questions will be used as appropriate to the extracts
- the 68-mark total for this section will be divided as appropriate between the eight questions: the questions will not necessarily be of equal weighting.
- The question on an unfamiliar piece of music will relate to one of the set works (but not a set work). Its purpose is for students to draw links from their study of the set works to the music heard as an unfamiliar extract. For example, it might be that following the study of the Star Wars music, another extract in a similar style will be used, although not necessarily by the same composer or from the same film track. A short skeleton score will be provided to help the student follow the music and provide reference points.